

Four

Bachtatonic/Rocktatonic

Inventions

*for Oboe, Clarinet in B flat
and Piano*

by
Christopher Kies

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Program Note

for

Four Bachtatonic/Rocktatonc Inventions for Oboe, Clarinet in B flat and Piano

In the Fall of 2018, I embarked on a project that grew out of my long-term fascination with the inherent capabilities of the octatonic scale to represent quasi-tonal effects in music. All I needed was a bad pun to get started, and that was the title: Bachtatonic etc.. As a pianist, I am very fond of J.S. Bach's great two- and three-part inventions. My first thought was to re-write some of those inventions using the three transpositions of the octatonic scale in which each of the Tonic, Dominant and Subdominant functions would be expressed through its own respective octatonic scale. Other, more remote, tonal roots could also be represented by one of the three octatonic transpositions since each scale contains four potentially "quasi-tonal" root tones. Once I had completed the re-writing of four of the two-part inventions in this manner, I realized that something was missing, and that was the element of surprise! For this, I borrowed on my similarly long-term admiration for the music of a certain British rock group from the 1960's. The second half of each of my inventions superimposes a famous tune by this rock group on top of the Bach piece. I had to make some adjustments to make these diverse pieces work together, but, in the end, it was surprisingly easy to do, thanks to the universally adaptable octatonic scales. To date, I have arranged these same four pieces for clarinet, marimba and piano, for two pianos, and for oboe, clarinet and piano. I hope that everyone will recognize some of their favorite classic rock tunes in this music.

---CK. 11.2020

Bachtatonic/Rocktatonc Invention No. 1

for oboe, clarinet, and piano

Score in C

by Christopher Kies
September 2018

The musical score is written for three instruments: Oboe, Clarinet in B flat, and Piano. The tempo is marked as $\text{♩} = 56$. The time signature is 3/8. The key signature is C major. The score is divided into two systems. The first system shows the Oboe and Clarinet parts, with the Piano part starting in the second measure. The Oboe part begins with a melodic line in the first measure, followed by a rest in the second measure. The Clarinet part is silent throughout the first system. The Piano part enters in the second measure with a melodic line. The second system shows the Oboe and Clarinet parts, with the Piano part continuing. The Oboe part has a melodic line in the first measure, followed by a rest in the second measure. The Clarinet part is silent throughout the second system. The Piano part continues with a melodic line. The score is marked with *mp* (mezzo-piano) for the Oboe and Piano parts.

Oboe

Clarinet in B flat

Piano

$\text{♩} = 56$

mp

5

5

Bachtatonic/Rocktatonc Invention No. 2

for oboe, clarinet, and piano

Score in C

by Christopher Kies
September 2018

The musical score is written for three instruments: Oboe, Clarinet in B flat, and Piano. The tempo is marked as 104 beats per minute, indicated by a quarter note followed by "= 104". The time signature is 3/8. The score is divided into two systems. The first system shows the Oboe and Clarinet staves, with the Piano part below them. The Oboe part begins with a melodic line, while the Clarinet and Piano parts are mostly rests. The second system shows the continuation of the pieces. The Oboe part has a measure marked with a box containing the number "5". The Clarinet part has a measure marked with a box containing the number "5". The Piano part has a measure marked with a box containing the number "5". The Piano part features a complex melodic line in the bass clef, with a dynamic marking of *mp* (mezzo-piano) and a *p* (piano) marking. The Oboe part has a dynamic marking of *mp* (mezzo-piano). The Clarinet part has a dynamic marking of *p* (piano).

Bachtatonic/Rocktatonc Invention No. 3

for oboe, clarinet, and piano

by Christopher Kies
September 2018

Score in C

First system of the musical score, measures 1-3. The Oboe part (treble clef) begins with a tempo marking of quarter note = 96 and a dynamic of *mp*. The Clarinet in B flat part (treble clef) begins with a dynamic of *p*. The Piano part (grand staff) is currently silent.

Second system of the musical score, measures 4-6. The Oboe part continues with a melodic line. The Clarinet in B flat part enters in measure 4 with a low note. The Piano part remains silent. Both systems 1 and 2 are marked with a box containing the number 4.

Bachtatonic/Rocktatonc Invention No. 4

Score in C

for oboe, clarinet, and piano

by Christopher Kies
September 2018

Score in C

Tempo: $\text{♩} = 112$

Oboe

Clarinet in B flat

Piano

mf

mf

mf

4

4

7

7

This musical score is for a piece titled "Bachtatonic/Rocktatonc Invention No. 4" by Christopher Kies, dated September 2018. The score is in C major and 3/4 time, with a tempo of 112 beats per minute. It is arranged for Oboe, Clarinet in B flat, and Piano. The first system (measures 1-3) shows the Oboe and Clarinet in B flat playing a melody, while the Piano part is silent. The second system (measures 4-6) shows the Piano part entering with a melody, while the Oboe and Clarinet in B flat are silent. The third system (measures 7-9) shows the Oboe and Clarinet in B flat playing a melody, while the Piano part is silent. The fourth system (measures 10-11) shows the Piano part playing a melody, while the Oboe and Clarinet in B flat are silent. The score is written in a standard musical notation with a key signature of one flat (Bb) and a time signature of 3/4. The dynamics are marked as mezzo-forte (mf). The score is divided into four systems, each with a measure number in a box (4, 4, 7, 7). The first system (measures 1-3) shows the Oboe and Clarinet in B flat playing a melody, while the Piano part is silent. The second system (measures 4-6) shows the Piano part entering with a melody, while the Oboe and Clarinet in B flat are silent. The third system (measures 7-9) shows the Oboe and Clarinet in B flat playing a melody, while the Piano part is silent. The fourth system (measures 10-11) shows the Piano part playing a melody, while the Oboe and Clarinet in B flat are silent.